

Who did you meet?

Find the character, then read across to your group. Every visit ends with a rung: one line to teach your family, and one more thing to go with it.



WHO WAS THERE THAT NIGHT

Grades K–2

The line, then the motion

Grades 3–4

The line, then the secret

Grades 5–7

The line, then a question for parents

Parents

The line, then a question for your child



Jacob

The dreamer

God was here, and I didn't even know it!

Hands on your cheeks like you're surprised. Then open your arms wide: here!

God was in this place, and I didn't know it.

I gave the place a new name: Beit El, House of God. Its old name was Luz.

God was in this place, and I didn't know it.

When have you been somewhere ordinary and only later realized it was special?

Surely God is present in this place, and I did not know it!

אכן יש ה' במקום הזה ואנכי לא ידעתי
Where is a place that feels special to you? Did you know it was special the first time you were there?



Esau

Jacob's twin brother

I was so angry... but one day I hugged my brother again.

Cross your arms and make an angry face. Then open your arms for a big hug.

Don't you have a blessing for me too?

Twenty years later, I ran to hug my brother, and we both cried.

Have you only one blessing?

Is there enough blessing in our family for everyone?

Have you but one blessing, Father?

הברכה אחת הוא-לך אבי
Do you ever feel like there isn't enough of me to go around?



Rebekah

Jacob's mother

I sent you away because I love you.

Give yourself a hug. Then wave goodbye.

Sometimes loving someone means letting them go.

In Hebrew, I told Jacob to stay away "a few days." It became twenty years.

I sent him away to keep him safe.

What's the hardest thing you've ever done because you love someone?

I said "a few days." It became twenty years.

ימים אחדים
What do you want to take with you when you leave home someday?



Isaac

Jacob's father

I gave you the blessing of Abraham. Take it with you.

I blessed Jacob twice: once when he tricked me, and once when he left home.

The second blessing was the one he didn't have to steal.

What blessing would you give me as I grow up?

May God give you the blessing of Abraham.

ויתן-לך את-ברכת אברהם
What blessing would you want from me?



An angel

On the ladder

Up and down, God is all around!

Climb with your hands: up, up, up... and down, down, down.

Your face is known in heaven.

The Sages said the angels went up to look at Jacob's picture in heaven, then came down and found him sleeping.

We went up and down to look at him.

Where do you see a little bit of God in me?

They looked for his face in heaven and found him asleep on earth.

עלים למעלה ורואים איקונין שלו, וירדים למטה ומוצאים אותו ישן
Where do you feel closest to God?



The stone

Jacob's pillow

We all wanted to help Jacob, so God made us one.

Make two fists and press them together into one.

A shaded box means that group didn't meet that character. The teachers are on the back.

The teachers

Rashi, the Sages, Ramban, and Rambam have been explaining Jacob's night for centuries. Grades 3–4 met Rashi and the Sages; grades 5–7 and the parents could meet all four.



WHO EXPLAINS IT			
	Grades 3–4 The line, then the secret	Grades 5–7 The line, then a question for parents	Parents The line, then a question for your child
 Rashi Teacher · France, 1040–1105	Look closely. Every word is a clue. <i>The angels changed shifts! The angels of the Land of Israel went up, and new angels came down to go with Jacob.</i>	Every word is a clue. <i>What's a small detail about our family that tells a big story?</i>	Every oddity in the text is a question waiting for you. <i>What's a question you have about the story?</i>
 The Sages The Midrash · about 1,500 years ago	The ladder could be many things. <i>Sulam (ladder) and Sinai add up to the same number: 130!</i>	Would you have climbed? <i>Would you have climbed? Why or why not?</i>	Would you have climbed? <i>Would you have climbed? What would have held you back?</i>
 Ramban Nachmanides · Spain, 1194–1270		You are in God's own care. <i>When have you felt taken care of by something bigger than you?</i>	You will be God's own portion. <i>When do you feel protected?</i>
 Rambam Maimonides · Spain and Egypt, about 1138–1204		Climb up to learn, then come back down to teach. <i>What's something you learned today that you could teach me?</i>	Climb up to learn, then come back down to teach. <i>Teach me something you learned today.</i>

THE STORY IN BRIEF GENESIS 27–28

Jacob tricked his father, Isaac, into giving him the blessing meant for his twin brother, Esau. Esau was so angry that their mother, Rebekah, sent Jacob away to her brother's house, just for a few days, she said. Before he left, Isaac blessed him again, this time on purpose. On the road, Jacob stopped for the night, put a stone under his head, and dreamed: a ladder stood on the ground with its top reaching the sky, and angels of God were going up and down on it. God stood beside him and promised, "I am with you." Jacob woke up and said, "Surely God is present in this place, and I did not know it!" He named the place Beit El, House of God.

WHEN SOMEONE TEACHES YOU A RUNG

- 1 Listen all the way through.
- 2 Say it back together, motion and all.
- 3 If they ask you a question, answer it.
- 4 Then teach them your rung.

A shaded box means that group didn't meet that teacher.